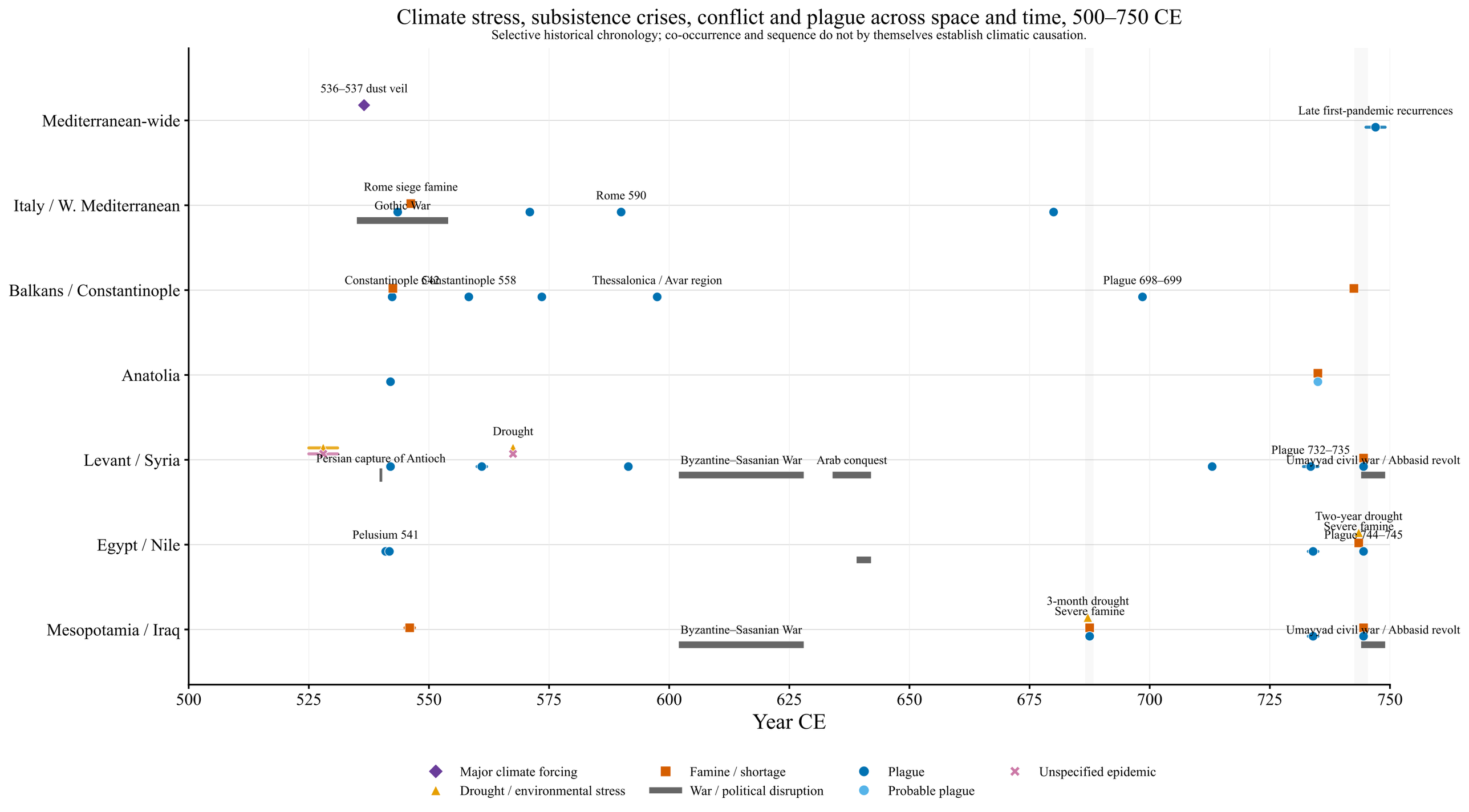
Climate stress, subsistence crises, conflict and plague across space and time, 500–750 CE
Selective historical chronology; co-occurrence and sequence do not by themselves establish climatic causation.
Mediterranean-wide
Italy / W. Mediterranean
Balkans / Constantinople
Anatolia
Levant / Syria
Egypt / Nile
Mesopotamia / Iraq
536–537 dust veil
Late first-pandemic recurrences
Rome siege famine
Gothic War
Rome 590
Constantinople 542
Constantinople 558
Thessalonica / Avar region
Plague 698–699
Drought
Persian capture of Antioch
Byzantine–Sasanian War
Arab conquest
Plague 732–735
Umayyad civil war / Abbasid revolt
Pelusium 541
Two-year drought
Severe famine
Plague 744–745
3-month drought
Severe famine
Byzantine–Sasanian War
Umayyad civil war / Abbasid revolt
500
525
550
575
600
625
650
675
700
725
750
Year CE
Major climate forcing
Famine / shortage
Plague
Unspecified epidemic
Drought / environmental stress
War / political disruption
Probable plague